

Installation Guide

This guide is for installing the pre-built application from a release package (`Setup.exe` or `Portable.exe`). If you need to build the application from source instead, see `BUILD_WINDOWS.md` in the source repository — that is a developer procedure, not needed for a normal installation.

1. System Requirements

Requirement	Minimum
Operating System	Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
Processor	Any 64-bit x86 processor from the last decade
Memory	4 GB RAM (8 GB recommended for larger employee counts)
Disk space	500 MB for the application; more for your database, backups, and exported reports as they accumulate
Network	Only required to reach biometric devices on your local network; the application itself does not require internet access
Permissions	Administrator rights for the one-time <code>Setup.exe</code> install step only

No separate Python installation, database server, or other runtime is required — everything the application needs is bundled into the installer/portable executable.

2. What's in the Release Package

Release/
├─ `Setup.exe` # Full installer (recommended for most users)
├─ `Portable.exe` # Standalone, no installation needed
├─ `CHANGELOG.md` # Full technical change history
├─ `Release Notes.pdf` # What's new in this version
├─ `Installation Guide.pdf` # This document
├─ `User Manual.pdf` # Day-to-day usage
├─ `Administrator Manual.pdf` # Licensing, roles, backups, troubleshooting
└─ `README.pdf` # Project overview

Choose `Setup.exe` for a normal installation with Start Menu/Desktop shortcuts and a proper uninstaller — this is the right choice for almost everyone. Choose `Portable.exe` only if you specifically need to run the application without installing anything (e.g. from a USB drive, or on a machine where you cannot get administrator rights even for the one-time install step).

3. Installing with `Setup.exe`

- 1 Copy `Setup.exe` to the target computer and run it.

- 2 If Windows shows a SmartScreen warning ("Windows protected your PC"), click More info then Run anyway — this is expected for an application that isn't yet code-signed with a commercial certificate; verify you obtained Setup.exe from a trusted source (your vendor) before proceeding.
- 3 Follow the setup wizard:
- 4 Accept the default install location (or choose another) — this step requires administrator rights.
- 5 Optionally check "Create a desktop icon".
- 6 Click Install, then Finish. You can launch the application immediately from the final wizard page.
- 7 The installer creates a Start Menu entry and (if selected) a Desktop shortcut, and registers the application under Windows' Apps & Features for later uninstallation.

No restart is required.

4. Installing with Portable.exe

- 1 Copy Portable.exe to any folder, USB drive, or network location.
- 2 Run it directly — no installation step, no administrator rights required.
- 3 The first launch is slightly slower than subsequent ones (it extracts to a temporary folder each time it starts); this is normal.

Portable.exe stores its data in the same location as an installed copy run under the same Windows user account (see section 6 below), so you can switch between a portable and installed copy on the same machine without losing data — they are the same application, just packaged differently.

5. First Run: License Activation and Initial Login

- 1 On first launch, the license activation screen appears. Enter the license key provided by your vendor and click Activate. An internet connection is not required for activation — the key is verified locally against a signature embedded in the application.
- 2 Once activated, you'll see the login screen with a company selector. If this is a brand-new installation with no company set up yet, follow your vendor's or administrator's initial company/admin-user setup instructions before logging in.
- 3 Log in with the username, password, and company provided by your administrator.

Every subsequent launch goes straight to the login screen — activation is a one-time step per machine (see the Administrator Guide if you need to move the license to a new machine).

6. Where Your Data Lives

The application never writes inside its own install folder. All data — the database, logs, backups, and exported files — lives under:

%LOCALAPPDATA%\AttendanceManagementSystem\

This folder is created automatically on first launch. It survives uninstalling and reinstalling (see below), and is never touched by upgrading to a newer version.

7. Upgrading to a Newer Version

Run the new version's Setup.exe over your existing installation — this performs an in-place upgrade. Your database, license activation, logs, and backups are untouched; only the application program files are replaced. No manual export/import step is needed.

If you use Portable.exe, simply replace the old file with the new one; your data (under %LOCALAPPDATA%) is shared between versions automatically.

8. Uninstalling

From Windows Settings → Apps (or the Start Menu shortcut), uninstall "Attendance Management System." The uninstaller removes the program files and then asks separately whether to also delete your data folder:

- No (recommended unless you're fully done with the application) — keeps your database, license, and logs in place in case you reinstall later.
- Yes — permanently deletes all attendance data, the license activation, and logs from this machine.

Portable.exe has no installer to run, so "uninstalling" it is simply deleting the file; your data folder is not touched and must be removed manually if you want it gone too.

9. Verifying the Installation

After installing, confirm:

- The application launches without any console window, Python traceback, or "missing DLL" error.
- The license activation screen (first run) or login screen (subsequent runs) appears correctly, with Arabic text rendering right-to-left.
- You can log in and see the dashboard.
- Exporting a PDF report shows correctly shaped Arabic text (this confirms the bundled font and text-shaping libraries are intact).

If any of these fail, see the Troubleshooting section of the Administrator Manual, or contact your vendor's support with the relevant log file from %LOCALAPPDATA%\AttendanceManagementSystem\logs\.

10. Next Steps

- New users: continue to the User Manual for day-to-day operation.
- Administrators: continue to the Administrator Manual for licensing details, multi-company setup, user/role management, backup practices, and troubleshooting.